

Generative AI and Labor Market Outcomes: Evidence from the United Kingdom

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Abstract

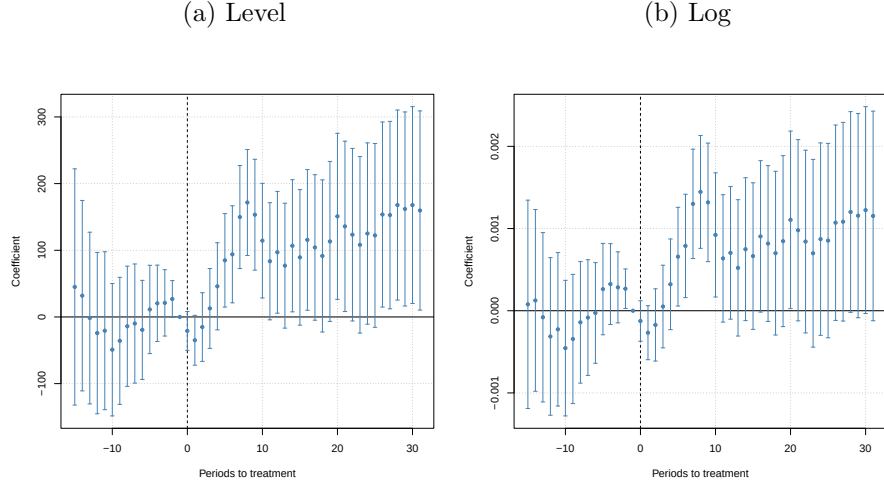
This paper examines the effects of LLMs on UK labor market outcomes. We use a difference-in-differences design that compares outcomes across firms and occupations from 2021 to 2025 based on their differential exposure to LLM capabilities. Our results show that highly exposed firms reduce employment, with effects concentrated in junior positions. These firms sharply curtail new hiring, with technical and creative roles experiencing the steepest declines. At the occupation level, roles more exposed to LLMs also show substantial reductions in job listings. The observed effects concentrate almost entirely in high-wage segments. Hence, our findings suggest that LLMs may compress wage inequality.

Keywords: Generative AI; Large Language Models; Automation; Labor demand; United Kingdom.

JEL: O33; J23; J31

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Figure 3: Effect of LLM exposure on firm-level compensation



Notes: This figure plots event study estimates of the effect of LLM exposure on average compensation within UK firms. Compensation is defined as annual base salary plus bonuses. Panel A shows compensation in levels, Panel B in logs. Coefficients are estimated from Equation (3) and are shown relative to October 2022, the final pre-treatment month. All regressions include firm fixed effects and industry-by-period fixed effects. Standard errors are clustered at the firm level. The vertical line marks November 2022, when ChatGPT was publicly released. Shaded areas denote 95% confidence intervals.

Figure 4 presents event study estimates for the probability that exposed vs. less exposed firms post any job vacancy in a given month. The results show a change in hiring patterns following November 2022. Prior to this date, firms with different exposure levels did not have statistically significantly different trends in job postings.⁸ Following the release of ChatGPT, however, we observe that a one standard deviation increase in LLM exposure reduces firms' likelihood of posting new jobs by 1.0 percentage point ($p < 0.001$, see Table A1). This effect emerges gradually and becomes statistically significant after approximately 10 months, mirroring the timeline of employment stock adjustments.

Next, we decompose the aggregate hiring reduction by estimating occupation-specific effects across job categories. We estimate Equation (4) separately for 50 distinct occupational categories, with the outcome variable indicating whether a

⁸Although all pre-trend estimates are statistically insignificant, the point estimates exhibit a slight downward drift. If this reflects a differential pre-trend rather than sampling variation, the post-treatment estimates may overstate the true effect.